



Debaser Mandate and Vision

Effective Date: 2026-01-20

Date Last Reviewed: 2026-02-20

Scheduled Review Date: 2028-02-20

Approved by: Debaser Board of Directors

MANDATE:

Debaser exists to...

1) Catalyze innovative and collaborative music and artistic projects via:

- a) Supporting artists at creation, production and presentation stages through commissions, residencies, exhibitions, and curated programming;
- b) Collaborating with local, national, and international partners to support the development of projects that serve common goals while multiplying community and organizational impacts;
- c) Music and artistic programming that is motivated by curation and community responsiveness.

2) Support underrepresented, equity-deserving, and outsider art and artists through:

- a) Supporting artists from or based on Anishinabe-Algonquin territory in the land colonially known as Canada;
- b) Prioritizing underrepresented and equity-deserving groups including but not limited to Indigenous, Black, people of colour, disabled, neurodivergent, displaced, 2SLGBTQIA+, women, and gender nonconforming artists;
- c) Prioritizing artists that work within alternative or “do-it-yourself” models of artistic and/or economic development, production, presentation, and dissemination;
- d) Presenting musical performances and artworks that are artist-driven, visionary, experimental, community-engaged and/or created to incite social change.

3) Create inclusive and responsive community spaces that cultivate shared understanding, joy, and social impact by:

- a) Following a care-centered approach for our community that promotes safety, accessibility, and anti-oppression, and supports self-directed forms of participation;
- b) Facilitating curation and discovery with an anti-colonial approach by prioritizing artistic self-determination and community responsiveness;
- c) Creating networks between local, national and international organizations for the benefit of artists, audiences and organizations.

OUR VISION FOR DEBASER IN 8 YEARS:

...as a music and arts presenter

- An internationally recognized music and arts presenter based on Anishinaabe-Algonquin territory, and trusted for its curation of diverse, experimental art and artists.
- An organization committed to curatorial, artistic and structural experimentation and innovation that is nourishing and responsive to the needs of the community.
- A builder of an arts scene where members have a deeper, richer, and more adventurous understanding and appreciation of music and art.



- A magnet for adventurous audiences from around the world.

...as a community builder

- A catalyst for the continued growth of a flourishing local underground music and arts community that encompasses a variety of mediums and genres.
- A supporter of a thriving, more equitable artistic ecosystem where artists feel valued and that their career in the arts is sustainable.
- A trusted partner of organizations at multiple levels, from grassroots collectives dedicated to social change to national art institutions and international presenters.
- An organizer that accommodates the diverse access needs and prioritizes the individual agency of community members through thoughtful programming, responsive planning, and continuous learning and unlearning.
- A key node in a network of avant-garde music and arts presenters across Turtle Island that strengthens and supports artistic careers through active sharing of resources, collaborative initiatives, and structural innovation.

...as a not-for-profit employer in the arts

- A sustainable arts employer and modeler of progressive employment practices whose activities support broader local creative economies.
- A steward of emerging talent in the arts through hands-on mentoring, experiential learning, and knowledge exchange.
- A model of a respectful and equitable working environment in the arts, and proponent of artistic accommodations that appropriately recognize the value of artistic labour.
- A leader for “DIY”-driven, transparent, equitable, and sustainable non-profit governance models.